

Esteban *Gimenez Zapiola*

REGIONAL CREATIVE DIRECTOR & CREATIVE AI LEAD · BCG

I run design as a business that drives revenue,
and I build the AI practice that scales it.

Sydney, Australia · working globally

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As Regional Creative Director at BCG I have direct reports across **APAC and Europe**, lead the creative practice areas, own the ANZ Creative Studio P&L and sit on the global leadership team. I am leading the shift of the whole in-house studio to AI-native: **33 Creative AI nodes** and a **global lab of 10**, with reach into 400+ designers. I work **embedded in the case team**, hands-on with MDPs, BCG X engineers and the client's own technical people.

I build agentic AI myself and take it to production. The building is how I lead: I write the first working version so there is something real to argue with, then hand it to the people who take it further.

| *Design isn't art. It's a discipline that moves revenue.*

EXPERIENCE

Nov 2024 – Present

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney · Global

Regional Creative Director & Creative AI Lead

- Founded and lead BCG Design Studios' **Creative AI practice**. Wrote the "*Creative Advantage*" proposal that made it the firm's Creative AI centre of excellence.
- Lead **33 Creative AI nodes across the regions** and a **global lab of 10 creative technologists**. I designed the structure, defined the roles and wrote the playbook, so a node runs without me.
- **Orchestrated 24 builders across squads** to ship a seven-product suite for senior partners, with handover docs and named owners in other regions.
- Designed the **Power Up Weeks** and run them through the regional leads. I write and teach the deep dives: graph and context engineering, prompting, agent loops, building agents in Claude and GPT. Ran a **global Creative AI hackathon** end to end, now a shared library of **49 skills** behind an automated review pipeline.
- **The only creative director in Design Studios running a global Creative AI programme while also delivering client work hands-on with ANZ case teams**. I lead the coded proof-of-concept **inside the pitch, not after it**, working with MDPs, **BCG X data scientists and engineers** and the client's own technical team. **Multiple proposals won that way** across agri-food, energy, convenience retail, beverages and banking. The win is never one person's. It takes BCG strategy plus design and creative craft.
- For an **aviation ground-services operator in Asia**, delivered the whole proposal: a pitch site, a film, and a **working product POC connected to real data**. Client-approved.
- Build and ship **agentic AI hands-on**: multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, an AI video pipeline, and a report engine that typesets long-form publications straight from the source. **Parla**, the native macOS dictation app I built from scratch, is now in daily use by BCGers well beyond my team and scaling across the firm.
- Lead the global practice across **six disciplines** and **400+ designers**, own the **ANZ Creative Studio P&L**, and sit on the global Design Studios leadership team. Hold BCG's "*Grow by Growing Others*" award. Pitched, launched and executive-produce **Business and Beyond**, BCG ANZ's flagship video podcast.
- **Outcomes**: 9–13% YoY revenue growth · ~2× regional scale · ~80% cross-border delivery · double-digit conversion lifts.

Nov 2021 – Oct 2024

BCG · Boston
Consulting Group

Sydney

Senior Creative Manager

Head of Creative ANZ & Co-Lead, Strategy ANZ. Built the foundation for the Global role.

- Grew ANZ Creative into one of BCG's strongest regional design practices; creative strategy contributing to **9–13% YoY revenue growth** across financial services, energy, retail, public sector, healthcare and tech.
- Co-led ANZ business strategy, at the table for positioning, growth and investment decisions; partnered with MDs, Partners and C-suite to shape transformation programs. Ran design as a commercial lever.
- Began embedding AI into the creative workflow, and grew senior designers into the leadership bench that earned the Global mandate.

Jun 2018 – Nov 2021

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Creative Lead, Endeavour Drinks · *Dan Murphy's*

Creative Lead for Dan Murphy's, Australia's #1 drinks retailer; also BWS, Jimmy Brings, Langtons and Cellarmasters.

- Sat on the **division leadership team** and helped grow the in-house team **from 4 people to 30**, into a full in-house agency serving the whole Endeavour portfolio, with up to **6 senior creatives** reporting to me.
- **Relaunched the Dan Murphy's brand from inside the in-house agency.** Built and governed the **Design System** (Frontify, InVision) behind it, the single source of truth for print, digital and coded templates. Restyled and rebranded **My Dan's**, the loyalty programme, alongside it.
- **Led creative for the digital business unit:** the danmurphys.com.au restyle (**≈2× audience**), the **Dan Murphy's app**, and a personalised programme producing **millions of tailored offers a day**. **Online went from under 1% of sales to 13–15%.**
- **We wrote the automation ourselves, years before any of it had a language model behind it.** A script laid out **240 product images a month** with their SKUs and prices, on brand, in minutes, to launch the catalogue offers, with personalised offers running in between. Oracle and Facebook then segmented price, offer and send timing, down to **weather-triggered creative**.
- Primary creative interface to the external agencies: **M&C Saatchi, Thinkerbell and Prospect** on mass media, Oracle on the martech.
- Designed **Direct to Boot**, our answer to Covid, whose design system was then **rolled out across the group, including BWS and Woolworths**. Then **Dan's Delivers**, our own delivery campaign, which I **executive-produced** from the shoot through to production assets for every medium.

Jun 2015 – Jun 2018

Endeavour Group

Sydney

Senior Digital Designer

In-house digital at agency pace, across Dan Murphy's, BWS, Langtons and Cellarmasters. Leading junior designers from the start.

- Hand-coded every EDM and the **dynamic personalisation** on Oracle Responsys behind Dan Murphy's segmented email programme, testing in **Litmus** and keeping each one rendering correctly across Outlook, Apple Mail and Gmail. We shipped our own **dark mode** for email before the platforms had one.
- Produced wireframes and restyled core components of danmurphys.com.au; led art direction and on-location shoots for tier-1 campaigns, lifting digital ROI.

2009 – 2015

Kasiopea · Brand
Chemistry
Mendioroz Design

Buenos Aires · Sydney

Senior UX/UI Designer · *Graphic Designer*

Generalist principal at a Buenos Aires digital agency (pharma, energy, talent, tech): art director, UX/UI designer, front-end developer, client lead and new-business pitcher. Clients incl. Duke Energy, Engie and Farmacity. Earlier, visual identity and **wayfinding** for airports and shopping centres, plus three winter seasons as a PSIA-certified ski instructor in Colorado.

CAPABILITIES

- Agentic AI, hands-on** · multi-agent systems, MCP servers, autonomous agents, a native app, prototype to production.
- Building the practice, not just the tool** · 33 nodes, a lab of 10 technologists, and 24 builders across squads who shipped a seven-product suite at my direction; playbooks and handover docs so it runs without me.
- Teaching it so it sticks** · Power Up Weeks run region by region, plus the deep dives I write and deliver.
- Design leadership at scale** · high-trust teams across regions and disciplines, coaching leaders into exceptional ones, across apps, websites, design systems, brand, journeys, editorial and motion.
- Strategic partnership & commercial design** · shoulder-to-shoulder with case teams, MDPs and the C-suite; owning a studio P&L, creative as a balance-sheet asset.

HONOURS

Grow by Growing *Others*

BOSTON CONSULTING GROUP

BCG award for leaders who lift the people around them: mentorship, and growing senior talent into leaders.

Ironman World Championship (*Hawaii*)

ELITE-AMATEUR TRIATHLETE

Multiple Ironman 70.3 age-group wins; qualified for the World Championship.

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

Mini-MBA, Business of Creativity · Future London Academy · 2025

Branding Now II · Future London Academy · 2022

Lic. Diseño de Imagen Empresaria & Diseñador Gráfico · Univ. de Palermo · 2009–13

Español (native) · English (full professional)